

The UPSC Syllabus, on One Page

The entire Civil Services Examination — Prelims, Mains, and Interview — laid out visually so you always know where you stand.

STAGE 1 — PRELIMS (SCREENING)		STAGE 2 — MAINS (WRITTEN)		STAGE 3 — INTERVIEW (PERSONALITY TEST)
Prelims		Mains — 9 Papers Total		
GS Paper I 200 marks Current events · History of India & National Movement · Indian & World Geography · Polity & Governance · Economic & Social Development · Environmental Ecology, Biodiversity & Climate Change · General Science		Paper A & B — Language 2 × 300, qualifying One Indian language (from the 8th Schedule) + English. Matriculation-level. 25% needed to qualify — marks not counted in merit, but failing disqualifies you outright.		
CSAT (GS Paper II) 200 marks · qualifying Comprehension · Interpersonal & communication skills · Logical reasoning & analytical ability · Decision-making & problem-solving · General mental ability · Basic numeracy (Class X level)		Essay 250 marks Two essays, chosen from a list of topics. Tests structure, originality and clarity of thought as much as content.		
Only GS Paper I marks count toward the Mains cutoff. CSAT just needs 33% to qualify — but don't neglect it.		GS I — Heritage, History & Geography 250 marks Indian Heritage & Culture · History of India & the World · Society · World & Indian Geography		
Interview		GS II — Governance & Polity 250 marks Constitution · Polity · Social Justice · Governance · International Relations		
Personality Test 275 marks A conversation based on your DAF (Detailed Application Form) — your background, hobbies, optional subject, work experience, and current affairs. Tests judgement and composure, not just knowledge.		GS III — Economy, Tech & Security 250 marks Technology · Economic Development · Biodiversity & Environment · Security · Disaster Management		
		GS IV — Ethics 250 marks Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude — including case studies		
		Optional Subject — Paper I & II 2 × 250 = 500 marks One subject you choose (Geography, Polity/PSIR and Psychology are especially well covered in our Mains Mastery Program)		
1750 MAINS MARKS TOWARD MERIT		275 INTERVIEW MARKS		2025 TOTAL FINAL MERIT MARKS